

Breaking Stereotypes



I remember an anecdote about a woman who, when introduced to some people as a “woman entrepreneur”, quickly corrected the person, saying: “Just call me an entrepreneur. They can see I am a woman.” Today, as more and more women come into the workforce, set up businesses on their own, get their hands dirty on the shop floor, and even draw up details of India’s space strategy, there is hardly any sector where women have not made their mark. Whether in policymaking, large companies, start-ups, or the capital markets, women achievers are dotting the Indian business landscape and demanding their rightful place.

But it’s not as if there aren’t challenges along the way. Whether it is the perennial one of balancing work and family commitments, returning to work after a maternity break, or getting the rightful place in the top management of a company, many women still have to put up a good fight to get what they deserve. Some figures tell the story. Aon’s *Voice of Women Study 2024, India*’ shows 42% of the women surveyed faced bias or potential bias at work, 37% say they face insensitive behaviour at the workplace and as much as 75% say they faced a career setback after maternity leave. But the good news is that many companies are now taking a serious look at many of these aspects and becoming more inclusive, providing flexible working hours and other facilities to help women employees. Equally, regulation has also helped, and currently 98% of NSE-listed companies have women directors, up from 88% in 2015, thanks to the stipulation in the Companies Act of 2013 that mandates all publicly listed companies must have at least one female director. However, these initiatives will truly have meaning only if they don’t remain mere tick-boxes and are implemented in letter and spirit.

Business Today’s 21st, much-awaited, listing of the Most Powerful Women in Business comes to you in these changing times, a period when the Indian economy is witnessing rapid change and women are driving much of that transformation in various fields. This year, we bring you 60 achievers, including five global winners. As you will see, each of these listers has driven change in their own way, defying stereotypes and carving their own niche in the world of business. In the process, they have inspired several others to follow in their footsteps and build what we like to call a “chain of empowerment”. That’s why we celebrate them year after year. This year’s list features 12 debutantes, while four women return to the list after a hiatus. The MPW 2024 list also has 37 repeat winners from last year. More power to all of them.

On a personal note, as I move on from *Business Today* to new adventures, I must say it has been nothing short of a privilege leading this iconic magazine and seeing the *BT* brand flourish now across print, online and video. The love and support we have received from you in bringing you stories of the new India is something I will cherish forever. *Au revoir!* **BT**

Sourav Majumdar

sourav.majumdar@aajtak.com
@TheSouravM

Business Today

<http://www.businesstoday.in>

Chairman & Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief: Kalli Purie
Group Chief Executive Officer: Dinesh Bhatia
Executive Director: Rahul Kanwal
Chief Operating Officer: Alok Nair
Editor: Sourav Majumdar
Group Creative Editor: Nilanjan Das
Group Photo Editor: Bandeep Singh

Managing Editor, Business Today TV: Siddharth Zarabi

Managing Editor: Anand Adhikari
Executive Editor: Krishna Gopalan

Executive Editor, Businesstoday.in: Arvin Vincent

CORRESPONDENTS

Economy Editor: Surabhi
Senior Editor: Neetu Chandra Sharma
Editor (Money Today): Teena Jain Kaushal
Associate Editor (Money Today): Navneet Dubey
Senior Assistant Editors: Arnab Dutta, Palak Agarwal, Richa Sharma
Senior Correspondents: Riddhima Bhatnagar, Sudeshna Mitra
Correspondent: Astha Oriel

RESEARCH

Chief of Research Bureau: Rahul Obero
Principal Research Analyst: Prince Tyagi

COPY DESK

Senior Editor: Abhik Sen
Senior Assistant Editors: Shishir Kumar Behera, Vikram Gopal
Assistant Editor: Bitasta Basu

PHOTOGRAPHY

Principal Photographer: Rajwant Singh Rawat
Staff Photographer: Hardik Chhabra
Photo Coordinator: Vidushi Mehrotra

ART

Creative Editor: Anirban Ghosh
Art Director: Rahul Sharma
Associate Art Director: Raj Verma
Chief Designer: Prabal Biswas

EVENTS

Senior Manager: Sourabh Dutta

PRODUCTION

Chief of Production: Harish Aggarwal
Deputy Manager: Narendra Singh
Production Coordinator: Ayeekam David Meitei

LIBRARY

Assistant Librarian: Satbir Singh
Executive Secretary: Somesh Varma

BUSINESS TEAM (MAGAZINE)

National Head-Business Today Magazine: Siddhartha Chatterjee
Assistant General Manager: Girish C

BUSINESS TEAM (BT TV)

National Head-BT TV: Masuma Parekh
Branch Head-North: Ankush Madan

AD OPS

Deputy General Manager: Avinash Karkera
Marketing: Vivek Malhotra, Group Chief Marketing Officer
Newsstand Sales: Deepak Bhatt, National Head-Distribution;
Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations); Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North); Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West)

Vol. 33, No. 24, for the fortnight November 11, 2024 to November 24, 2024. Released on November 11, 2024.

● Editorial Office: India Today Mediaplex, FC 8, Sector 16/A, Film City, Noida 201301; Tel: 0120-4807100; Fax: 0120-4807150 ● Advertising Office (Gurgaon): A1-A2, Enkay Centre, Ground Floor, V.N. Commercial Complex, Udyog Vihar, Phase 5, Gurgaon-122001; Tel: 0124-4948400; Fax: 0124-4030919; Mumbai: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One World Center (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Tel: 022-69193355; Fax: 022-66063226; Chennai: 5th Floor, Main Building No. 443, Guna Complex, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai-600018; Tel: 044-28478525; Fax: 044-24361942; Bangalore: 202-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Tel: 080-22212448, 080-30374106; Fax: 080-22218335; Kolkata: 52, J.L. Road, 4th floor, Kolkata-700071; Tel: 033-22825398, 033-22827726, 033-22821922; Fax: 033-22827254; Hyderabad: 6-3-885/7/B, Raj Bhawan Road, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Tel: 040-23401657, 040-23400479; Ahmedabad: 2nd Floor, 2C, Surya Rath Building, Behind White House, Panchwati, Off. C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Tel: 079-6560393, 079-6560929; Fax: 079-6565293; Kochi: Karakkatt Road, Kochi-682016; Tel: 0484-2377057, 0484-2377058; Fax: 0484-370962 ● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP) - 201301. Email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am-6 pm)

● Sales: General Manager Sales, Living Media India Ltd, C-9, Sector 10, Noida (U.P.) - 201301; Tel: 0120-4019500; Fax: 0120-4019664 © 1998 Living Media India Ltd.

All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

● Printed & published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35, Milestone, Delhi-Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana). Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. Editor: Sourav Majumdar

● Business Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only.



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000

www.syndicationstoday.in